

JSS 1 SOCIAL AND CITIZENSHIP STUDIES

FIRST TERM

TOPIC 1: CITIZENSHIP

1. Meaning of Citizenship

Citizenship is the legal status of being a full and recognised member of a country or nation. A citizen is a person who belongs to a particular country and enjoys the rights and privileges given by that country while also having duties and responsibilities towards it.

In simple terms, citizenship means being a member of a state with full rights and obligations under the law of that state.

2. Ways of Becoming a Citizen

There are several ways a person can become a citizen of a country such as Nigeria:

a) By Birth (Citizenship by Birth)

- A person born in Nigeria to Nigerian parents is automatically a citizen.
- A person born outside Nigeria whose parents (or one parent) are Nigerian citizens may also claim citizenship by birth.

b) By Registration

- A foreign woman married to a Nigerian man can apply for citizenship by registration.
- A person of full age and capacity who has lived in Nigeria for a continuous period may also apply under certain conditions.

c) By Naturalisation

- A foreigner who has lived in Nigeria for a long period (usually 15 years or more), is of good character, and has shown intention to remain in Nigeria can apply for naturalisation.
- The person must renounce previous citizenship (if required) and take an oath of allegiance.

d) By Descent / Inheritance

- Citizenship can be passed from parents to children even if the child is born abroad.

3. Importance of Being a Good Citizen

- It promotes peace, order and development in the society.
- It helps the government to function effectively through cooperation and support.
- Good citizens protect public property and the environment.
- It builds national unity and patriotism.
- It ensures that rights are respected and duties are performed.
- Good citizenship reduces crime, corruption and social problems.

4. Qualities of a Responsible Citizen

A responsible citizen should possess the following qualities:

- **Honesty and Integrity** – truthful and trustworthy in all dealings.
- **Patriotism** – love and loyalty to one's country.
- **Obedience to the Law** – respects and obeys the laws of the land.
- **Respect for Others** – respects the rights, culture and opinions of others.
- **Hard Work and Diligence** – contributes positively through work and education.

- **Tolerance and Peacefulness** – lives in peace with people of different backgrounds.
- **Willingness to Help** – assists others and participates in community development.
- **Accountability** – takes responsibility for one's actions.
- **Environmental Consciousness** – cares for the environment and public facilities.

5. Summary

Citizenship is membership of a country with full rights and duties. A person can become a citizen by birth, registration, naturalisation or descent. Being a good and responsible citizen is essential for national progress, peace and unity. Every student should strive to develop the qualities of a good citizen from an early age.

End of Topic 1 – Citizenship